MINUTES
OAKWOOD CITY COUNCIL WORK SESSION
JUNE 1, 2026

The Council of the City of Oakwood, Ohio, met in a work session on Monday, June 1, 2026, in the conference room at the City Building, located at 30 Park Avenue. The Vice Mayor, Steve Byington, presided.

Council members in attendance were Vice Mayor Steve Byington, Leigh Turben, Healy Jackson, and Sam Dorf. Mayor William Duncan was excused absent. Staff members were City Manager Katie Smiddy and City Attorney Rob Jacques.

Vice Mayor Steve Byington called the work session to order at 6:30 p.m. and reviewed the agenda for the regular session this evening. Thereafter, he led a discussion on the following agenda items:

- STATUS REPORTS:
  - Citizen Committee Appointments: Vice Mayor Steve Byington announced that he would call for a vote during the regular meeting to appoint members to the Beautification Committee and the Board of Zoning Appeals.

- VISITORS:
  - Montgomery County Recorder's Office: Nate Mundy, External Communications Manager for the Montgomery County Recorder's Office, will provide an overview of the office's programs, services, and recent initiatives.
  - Oakwood Inclusion Coalition (OIC) Annual Report: Kate Furmanski, OIC member, will present the organization's annual report, highlighting its activities, accomplishments, and community engagement efforts over the past year.

- LEGISLATION: Council discussed the following item of legislation scheduled for the regular session this evening:
  - A Resolution to place a 2.72 mill renewal tax levy on the November 3, 2026 ballot, Vice Mayor Byington

- MISCELLANEOUS
  - Mrs. Jackson briefly discussed the honorary brick paver that will be installed at Smith Gardens in recognition of former Councilmember Stephens.
  - Mrs. Smiddy updated Council on the Oakwood Inclusion Coalition's (OIC) Longest Table event scheduled for Thursday, June 4.
  - Mrs. Smiddy informed Council that the Safety Department is launching a five-part social media series focused on e-bike safety.
  - Mrs. Smiddy reported that 73 responses had been received to date for the Communications Survey and noted that a reminder campaign is planned prior to the June 30 deadline. Council discussed various methods of promoting participation in the survey.
  - Mrs. Smiddy provided an update on two recent meetings with Oakwood City School District Superintendent Neil Gupta. The first meeting, which included Wright Library Director Kristi Hale, focused on coordinating messaging regarding the potential elimination of property taxes in Ohio. Council discussed the issue at length. The second meeting involved City staff and representatives of the School District regarding the planned renovation project at Smith and Harman Elementary Schools. Council discussed challenges associated with the various project options under consideration.

- Mr. Dorf reported that he recently spoke with John Wilson, a member of the Oakwood City School District Board of Education, regarding opportunities to strengthen engagement and communication between City Council and the Board.
- Mrs. Smiddy shared an inquiry from Mayor Duncan regarding a potential City contribution to the Police Officers Memorial Fund and noted that the matter would be discussed at a future work session when the Mayor is present.
- Mrs. Smiddy informed Council that she and Mayor Duncan have discussed the possibility of updating the City Charter. She stated that Mr. Jacques has been asked to prepare a proposed timeline and outline of the charter amendment process. Council discussed approaches to public education and engagement and suggested that any initial charter amendments be considered for the November 2027 ballot.
- Mrs. Jackson reported that she and Mrs. Smiddy recently met to discuss the Annual Report. Mrs. Jackson expressed concerns regarding the format of the written draft and indicated a preference for the report to be presented verbally by Mrs. Smiddy at a Council meeting. Council discussed the matter extensively. Following discussion, Vice Mayor Byington requested that Mrs. Smiddy provide a revised written draft for further review at the June 15 work session.
- Vice Mayor Byington noted that a significant number of emails had been distributed to Councilmembers on the day of the work session. He commented that Councilmembers may not always have sufficient time to review extensive materials immediately before a meeting and requested that information be distributed earlier whenever possible.
- Mr. Dorf offered to invite a representative from the Small Business Development Coalition (SBDC) to a future work session to provide information on programs and services that may benefit Oakwood businesses. Council briefly discussed the suggestion and expressed support for the idea.

At 7:27 p.m., Vice Mayor Byington concluded the work session, and Council moved to regular session.

William D Duncan

Mayor

ATTEST:

Lori Stacy

Clerk of Council